

Character AI's use of water

Posted by u/prettylacey_ • 0 points • 3 comments

I see a lot of people, especially more recently, claiming that Character AI wastes water. This claim comes from the fact that CAI uses water to cool down the AI computer system used to generate the replies from chat bots, which is then evaporated (I believe). But in this case, if the water used is evaporated, shouldn't it, in theory, return to earth in the form of precipitation, resulting in no water actually being wasted? I'm struggling to find the answer here. Any responses from some smarter-than-me people that could help me out with this are appreciated! :)

Comments

u/Lopsided_Drawer6363 • 2 points • 2025-07-11 16:08 UTC

It's not entirely wrong: AI models do require a great deal of water.

There's an interesting article by MIT:

Explained: Generative AI's environmental impact | MIT News | Massachusetts Institute of Technology
<https://share.google/pv1vZoSfLmtuHXyVh>

Mind you, the same could be said for Blockchain technologies, crypto, and anything that requires a lot of computing power.

In Character AI case, however, the impact could be less: their model is not exactly on par with ChatGPT.

u/MemeLite10 • 1 points • 2025-10-03 22:46 UTC

I assume so, but there's not enough data to make a definitive conclusion, someone would have to do research around their databases, and who knows where they're located.

u/Kitchen_Designer190 • 10 points • 2025-07-08 21:25 UTC

If the water is evaporated, then no, nothing would be wasted. Law of Conservation of Energy and all that. I'm not a scientist, nor do I know how the AI system works, but if your statement is true, then I don't think we c.ai users have anything to worry about.

u/Fit_Ad1220 • 1 points • 2025-07-10 12:57 UTC

that's true but AI uses more water than what's being restored. It is why Memphis no longer has drinking water. More people using AI = Takes more water that could be restored = People losing their drinking water. Just stop using Ai

u/EgirlFox • 8 points • 2025-07-08 21:24 UTC

It's a little more than what's already used for cooling. Don't worry about it being anything crazy like people say.

u/EgirlFox • 9 points • 2025-07-08 21:24 UTC

and yes, it evaporates and turns back into usable water.

u/Fit_Ad1220 • 2 points • 2025-07-10 12:56 UTC

that's true but AI uses more water than what's being restored. It is why Memphis no longer has drinking water. More people using AI = Takes more water that could be restored = People losing their drinking water. Just stop using Ai